



What About NPOs? Identifying Factors in the Intention to Donate: The Role of Brand Identification and Past Behavior

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Abstract In this study, the factors that determine the intentions of individuals to donate to nonprofit organizations (NPOs) were analyzed. Based on an extensive review of the academic literature, research hypotheses were proposed about the influences of altruism, self-esteem, trust, donation past behavior, attitudes and brand identification. Data were collected by means of an online survey. The sample was composed of 300 respondents. The empirical investigation consisted of specifying and estimating a model using PLS-SEM. The results showed that altruism and self-esteem did not have statistically significant effects on the intention to donate. The findings suggested that donations to NPOs were more strongly influenced by trust, past donation behavior, attitudes, and brand identification. The paper discusses implications of these results for theory and managerial practices related to philanthropy.

Keywords Intention to donate · Nonprofit organizations · Past behavior · Trust · Brand identification

Introduction

Nonprofit organizations (NPOs) must have a detailed understanding of the donation process to obtain contributions and attract new donors, especially when their goal is to sustain the donor relationship over a long period of time. A better comprehension of donors' 'preferences will allow NPOs to personalize the fundraising process and attract more donations (Sieg & Zhang, 2012).

The current literature in the field of philanthropy has employed the theory of planned behavior (TPB), which was introduced by Ajzen (1991). For example, Smith and McSweeney (2007), Van der Linden (2011), Knowles et al. (2012), and Sura et al. (2017) applied TPB as an exploratory model of human donation intentions and proved its efficacy. According to this model, intention is the main determinant of donation behavior. In turn, intention is determined by positive or negative evaluations of the behavior (attitude), perceptions of social pressure to perform the behavior (subjective norm) and perceptions of control over performing the behavior (perceived control). However, instead of using the classic TPB model, Kashif et al. (2015), Knowles et al. (2012), and Smith and McSweeney (2007) framed their research using the extended version (ETPB). The ETPB model distinguishes between subjective norms and descriptive norms, specifically, imperative norms and descriptive norms, to provide a broader justification for charitable intention. In addition, these studies enhanced the original model by incorporating the role of past behavior as a predictor of intention to donate. Although the TPB and ETPB models have been the dominant approaches, more recent studies have suggested the need to consider other factors.

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Individuals may have many reasons for donating, including simultaneous motivations related to both private and public benefits.

This concept of public versus private benefits have been widely explored in the academic literature and has been used as an operational guiding framework for possible methods to measure the motivation to donate money or time. According to some previous studies, motives associated with public benefits include altruism, trust in charities, and trust. In contrast, motives related to private benefits include egoism, fiscal incentives, guilt, donation attitude, past donation behavior and self-esteem (Konrath & Handy, 2018).

Other studies have analyzed the concept of nonprofit brand image and attempted to identify its impact. However, conventional approaches to nonprofit branding have been limited, and there is disagreement about what constitutes a strong brand in the nonprofit sector (Boenigk & Becker, 2016; Michel & Reieunier, 2012).

In summary, the current research literature on the factors that determine charitable giving is large. We have conducted an extensive review of studies that refer to the intention to donate (Table 1). This review allows us to state that there is a wide variety of approaches and models. At present, there is no global model that integrates the factors proposed by ETPB theory and other factors suggested by recent studies, such as altruism, trust, self-esteem, and brand identification.

The present study attempts to address this gap in the literature. With this purpose in mind, the objective of this paper is to explore the influence of different intrinsic motivations, specifically altruism, trust, past behavior, self-

esteem, donor attitude and brand identification, on the intention to donate to NPOs. While these factors were analyzed separately in previous studies, few attempts were made to formulate a comprehensive explanatory model. The exploration of new donation mechanisms with the inclusion of new variables is relevant because current models of individual donor behavior require better theoretical foundations to justify their potential for future research and theoretical development.

Understanding individual donor behavior is useful for professional fundraising because NPO managers can use this information to identify donor profiles to target their campaigns to those who are most likely to donate and be most generous.

This paper first examines the literature on donor motivation and develops hypotheses on how these factors influence donation intentions. On the basis of the proposed hypotheses, an explanatory model is defined. In the next section, we describe our methodology and results, and then we provide a discussion of the theoretical and managerial implications for NPOs.

Literature Review and Hypothesis Development

Research on individuals' motives, intentions and forms of giving has been supported by a variety of studies from the disciplines of anthropology, clinical psychology, and classical economics, and more recently management and marketing, which has led to the formulation of numerous models and theories (Michaelidou et al., 2015; Sargeant & Woodliffe, 2007).

Table 1 Review of the main studies focusing on modelling intention to donate

Author (s)	Theories	Factors/Variables
Smith and McSweeney (2007)	Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB)	Perceived Behavioural Control; Attitude; Injunctive Norm; Descriptive Norm; Moral Norm; Past Behaviour; Behavioural Intention; Behaviour
Winterich et al. (2012)	Moral Foundation Theory	Political Identity; Moral Identity Internalization; Charity Management Process; Donation Intentions
Kashif et al. (2015)	Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB)	Perceived Behavioural; Attitude; Injunctive Norm; Descriptive Norm; Moral Norm; Past Behaviour; Behavioural Intention; Behaviour
Wallace et al. (2017)	Conspicuous Donation Behaviour	Self-esteem; Materialism; Self-monitoring; Conspicuous Donation Behaviour; Volunteer time; Donate money
Mittelman and Rojas-Méndez (2018)	Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB)	Intention to Donate; Attitude toward Donation; Attitude toward Helping Others; Attitude toward Charity; Perceived Behavioural Control; Subjective Norms; Moral Norms; Past Behaviour
Dogan et al., (2021)	Social identity theory	Organizational factors: Familiarity; Typicality; Brand Image; Past Donation; Intention to donation
Minguez and Sese (2021)	Social Influence	Descriptive and Injunctive Norms; Affinity with the cause; Past Giving Behavior; Intention to donate
Müller and Lindenmeier (2022)	Charitable ethnocentrism theory	Trust; Altruism; Social; Egoism; Tax; Financial Constraints; Charitable Ethnocentrism; Intention to Donate to International Causes

Based on an extensive review of previous studies, we have considered two psychological factors (altruism and self-esteem) and four behavioral factors (trust, past behavior, donor attitude and brand identification) in this study. The predictive value of these factors in explaining the intention to donate to NPOs is well documented in the academic literature.

Altruism

Altruism was described by Brewer (2003) as a cognitive activity to help others. Moreover, altruism is a personal characteristic that represents personal social responsibility and a sense of mission (Rodríguez-Ricardo et al., 2019).

According to Konrath and Handy (2018), altruism is the motivation that describes why individuals voluntarily give up their private resources in exchange for goods and services that improve the well-being of others.

In the context of conventional charity, it has long been recognized that altruistic motives drive charitable behaviors (Cecere et al., 2017; Echazu & Nocetti, 2015). Altruism is an interdisciplinary construct, although each discipline seems to differ in its conception and use of the term. In this research area, social psychology researchers examine altruism in comparison to egoism. Scholars have advocated the investigation of altruism on a motivational continuum from altruistic to egotistic as opposed to using a dichotomous model (Piatak & Holt, 2020).

Taking into account the findings of the previous studies discussed above, the following research hypothesis is proposed in this paper:

Hypothesis 1 (H1) Altruism is positively associated with the intention to donate to NPOs.

Self-esteem

High self-esteem is related to enhanced initiative and higher levels of volunteerism (Briggs et al., 2007). According to the literature on donations, people are motivated to give money and time to achieve prestige, respect, and reputation (Sargeant et al., 2006; Tiltay & Torlak, 2020). Other previous studies found that self-esteem is an important factor that influences engagement in altruistic behaviors (Fu et al., 2017; Zheng et al., 2021).

Donating money or time to others can also increase the donor's self-esteem and self-confidence by making the donor feel more confident and competent (Zhang, 2009).

In this line of research, Wallace et al. (2017) establish that self-esteem is an antecedent of donation behavior. Similarly, Winterich et al. (2013) argued that being known and respected are often effective motivations of giving behavior. Because of the intrinsic advantages of high self-

esteem, it is considered an important driver of voluntary giving. The following is therefore posited:

Hypothesis 2 (H2) Self-esteem is positively associated with the intention to donate to NPOs.

Trust

Trust is considered to be one of the principal factors influencing donation intentions (Burt, 2014; Liu et al., 2018). On this issue, Bennett and Barkensjo (2005) claimed that trust is important in the context of donation, as it indicates the sense of assurance that the NPO will use donations appropriately.

Studies based on the economic theory of charitable giving have empirically demonstrated that individuals often make donations expecting some benefit or incentive in return. One of the most common examples of this benefit is the tax deduction that is gained after the donation (Khurana, 2021). Most studies have suggested that the greater the opportunity for tax deductibility of donations, the larger the amounts of donations (Cagé & Gillot, 2021; Kumar & Chakrabarti, 2021). However, tax policy varies from nation to nation (Scharf & Smith, 2015; Müller & Lindenmeier, 2022), and only a few studies have explicitly assessed the impact of advertising deductibility (Saeri et al., 2022).

Although many studies have analyzed the relationship between trust and giving, the results have been very mixed, with bivariate correlations ranging from positive (e.g., Ranganathan & Sen, 2012) to negative (e.g., Treiblmaier & Pollach, 2008), and sometimes with no statistically significant association detected (e.g., Lin, 2021).

To resolve this controversy, Chapman et al. (2021) recently conducted a systematic review of research published between 1988 and 2020. Those authors found a significant relationship between trust and donations, but it is important to emphasize that the available evidence does not address the question of causality. Therefore, it remains unclear whether trust is a determinant or a consequence of charitable giving. It can be concluded that despite the strong assumption that trust is important in encouraging donations, the evidence supports only a positive association, not a causal relationship.

In accordance with the above findings, in our study, we intend to test whether trust is a determinant of donation intention behavior. This study therefore hypothesizes the following:

Hypothesis 3 (H3) Trust in NPOs is positively associated with the intention to donate to NPOs.

Past Behavior

Past behavior has been considered an important determinant of prosocial behaviors, including charitable giving (Knowles et al., 2012; Mittelman & Rojas-Méndez, 2018; Smith & McSweeney, 2007; Van der Linden, 2011).

However, previous studies have shown that past behavior is not by itself a predictor of future donation behavior because it is mediated by other factors. On this issue, Ajzen (2002) asserted that past behavior cannot be treated exclusively as a sole causal factor, nor should past behavior be accepted as an effective indicator of habit. Other factors that have not been taken into consideration could also contribute to the influence of habit because habit is not explicitly represented in the theoretical models (Van der Linden, 2011).

More precisely, in the context of charitable giving, Rosen and Sims (2011) established that charitable behavior is most likely a learned habit, as they found that donating time and money in adolescence was a strong predictor of charitable behavior in adulthood.

There is sufficient theoretical support to consider past behavior as a determining factor of charitable giving in this study. These findings lead to the following hypothesis:

Hypothesis 4 (H4) Past donation to NPOs is positively associated with intention to donate to NPOs.

Donor Attitude

The prospective donor attitude toward the person who requests the donation could make a crucial contribution to the effectiveness of donation campaigns (Peasley et al., 2018). Researchers need measures of attitudes toward charitable giving to further develop and empirically test theories of charitable giving behavior (Ranganathan & Henley, 2008). In this context, previous studies have differentiated between attitudes toward helping others and attitudes toward charitable organizations.

Webb et al. (2000) maintain that for individuals with a positive attitude toward helping others, donating to charities is only one way to achieve the goal of helping others. This attitude involves “*global and relatively enduring evaluations with respect to helping or assisting others*” (Webb et al., 2000, p. 300).

Furthermore, those authors stated with confidence that attitudes toward donating to charity are positively correlated with charitable giving, and that individuals with strong positive attitudes toward philanthropy donated to charities. In summary, attitude toward helping others is generic in nature and can be considered an antecedent of attitude toward charitable organizations. In our study, we directly consider attitude toward charity donations.

Previous empirical evidence demonstrated that attitudes toward charitable donations influenced the willingness or intention to donate (Gorczyca & Hartman, 2017; Mittelman & Rojas-Méndez, 2018; Peasley et al., 2018). Accordingly, we hypothesize the following:

Hypothesis 5 (H5) Donors’ attitudes positively influence the intention to donate to NPOs.

Brand Identification

When an individual identifies with a NPO, he or she commits himself to the successes and failures of the organization. This suggests that individuals who identify with an NPO are more likely to patronize the organization because the success of the NPO is also their success (Cornwell & Coote, 2005).

In this regard, it can be stated that donors always have a more positive attitude and a stronger intention to donate to NPOs that have a brand that is more congruent with their own self-concept (Hou et al., 2014).

In summary, the literature on identification suggests that NPOs seeking to encourage retention should think about the different identities of their donors. Helping donors foster a favorable self-image, not only because they are donors but also because of the values to which they aspire or already hold, is an effective strategy for NPOs to strengthen their communication campaigns and fundraising (Sargeant, 2013). This leads to the following hypothesis:

Hypothesis 6 (H6) Identification with an NPO’s brand is positively associated with intention to donate to that NPO.

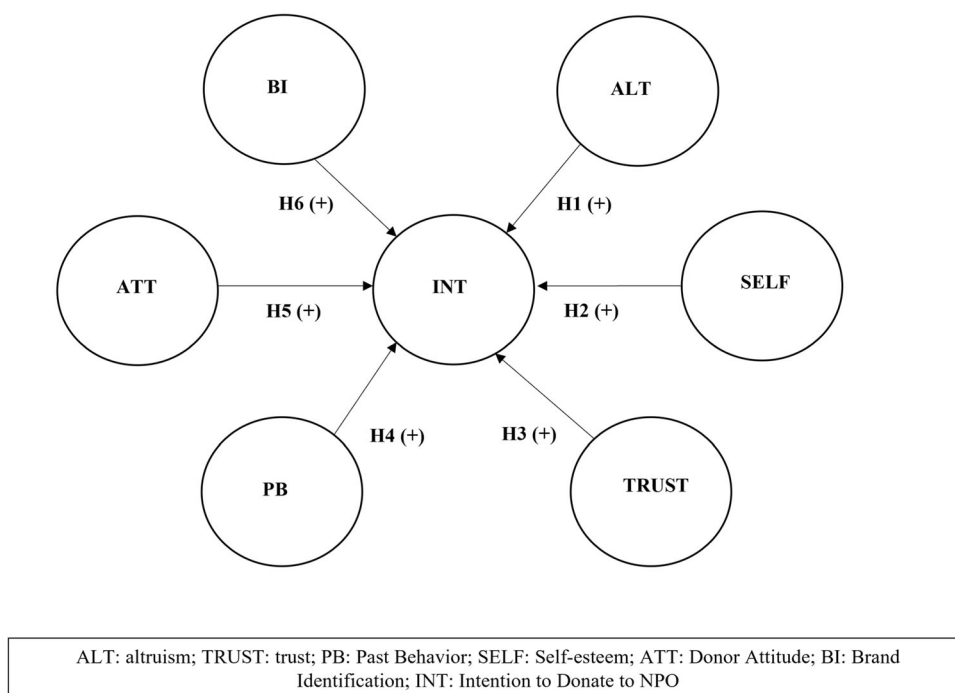
Based on the above discussion, Fig. 1 summarizes the hypotheses of the proposed conceptual model (see Fig. 1).

Methodology

Data Collection and Sample Profile

In this research, 300 valid surveys were obtained using an online survey platform to increase dissemination. The data were collected from January to April 2022. The study population consisted of NPO donors. In addition, all respondents were over 18 years of age, included members of both sexes, and were residents of Spain. Participants were recruited through social media, e-mail, and snowball sampling (Table 2).

The PLS–SEM technique requires a minimum sample size. Using G*Power 3.1.9.4, the statistical power value for this sample was 0.999, which is higher than the established minimum of 0.8 (Hair et al., 2019). Therefore, the sample size was acceptable for the purposes of this study.

Fig. 1 The proposed conceptual model**Table 2** Sample profile

Characteristics		Sample (percentage)
Sex	Male	58.0
	Female	42.0
Age	18–24	51.7
	25–34	11.3
	35–44	12.0
	45–54	16.3
	55–64	4.7
	> 65	4.0
Education	No formal education or primary	2.7
	Secondary	32.4
	University	64.9
Occupation	Employed person	36.7
	Unemployed	63.3
Affiliated with an NPO	Yes	79.3
	No	20.7
Donation frequency	The respondent had donated in the last three months	62.0
	The respondent had not donated in the last three months	38.0
Volunteer for a non-governmental organization	Yes	82.3
	No	17.7

By gender distribution, 58% of the respondents were women, and 42% were men. By age, the largest age group included individuals younger than 25 years of age (51.7%); individuals over 25 years of age comprised 48.3% of the sample. Regarding whether the respondents were affiliated

with an NPO, 79.3% belonged to an association, while 20.7% were not affiliated with an NPO. Furthermore, 62% of the respondents reported that they had donated in the last three months compared to 38% who had not donated.

Instrument

The questionnaire first included questions related the general sociodemographic information. Next, the questions assessing the variables measured in the study were presented using a 7-position Likert-type scale (1 being totally

disagree and 7 being totally agree). Each factor is described in Table 3 (Table 3).

Statistical Procedures

To evaluate the proposed conceptual model, the partial least squares structural equation modeling (PLS-SEM)

Table 3 Measurement of key concepts

Construct	Adapted items	Scale origin
Altruism (ALT)	ALT1: I donate (money) because I feel compassion toward people in need ALT2: People should be willing to help others who are less fortunate ALT3: I donate money because I am concerned about those who less fortunate than myself	Steele et al. (2008), Konrath and Handy (2018)
Trust	TRUST1: I would trust this nonprofit organization to always act in the best interest of the cause TRUST2: I would trust this nonprofit organization to conduct their operations ethically TRUST3: I would trust this nonprofit organization to use donated funds appropriately TRUST4: I would trust this nonprofit organization not to exploit their donors TRUST5: I would trust this nonprofit organization to use fundraising techniques that are appropriate and sensitive	Sargeant et al. (2006)
Past behaviour (PB)	PAST1: I usually donate money to charities and nonprofit organization PAST2: Over the past months, I have donated money to charities and nonprofit organizations PAST3: I have donated money to a nonprofit organization on several occasions in the past	Smith and McSweeney (2007)
Self-esteem (SELF)	SELF1: Giving money to a nonprofit organization makes me feel better about myself SELF2: Giving to charities makes me feel powerful SELF3: Contributing money to charities enables me to obtain recognition	Konrath and Handy (2018)
Donor attitude (ATT)	ATT1: Pleasant/Unpleasant ATT2: Useful/Useless ATT3: Satisfying/Unsatisfying ATT4: Favourable/Unfavourable ATT5: Positive/Negative ATT6: Considerate/Inconsiderate ATT7: Worthwhile/Pointless ATT8: Good/Bad	Smith and McSweeney (2007)
Brand identification (BI)	BI1: I feel a strong sense of belonging to this nonprofit organization BI2: I identify strongly with this nonprofit organization BI3: This nonprofit organization embodies what I believe in BI4: This nonprofit organization is like a part of me BI5: This nonprofit organization has a great deal of personal meaning for me	Stokburger-Sauer et al. (2012)
Intention to donate to NPO (INT)	INT1: I will donate money to charities or community service organizations in the next 4 weeks INT2: I would like to donate money to charities or community service organizations in the next 4 weeks	Smith and McSweeney (2007)

approach was used. PLS-SEM is defined as a variance-based method used to assess composite-based path models (Hair et al., 2019). PLS-SEM guidelines consistently recommend that the purpose rather than the data characteristics of a study should motivate the choice of PLS-SEM (Hair et al., 2022; Magno et al., 2022). All our measures were operationalized as composites (Henseler, 2017), and our study adopted an explanatory approach. Finally, PLS-SEM provides fixed latent variable scores, which are required to run an IPMA (Nunkoo et al., 2020; Ringle & Sarstedt, 2016).

To estimate the proposed model, Smart PLS 3.3.9 was utilized. We followed the indications of the PLS-SEM literature to evaluate the model and assessed (1) the measurement model and (2) the structural model (Hair et al., 2019), and we performed (3) IPMA analysis (Ringle & Sarstedt, 2016).

Results

First, the measurement model for intention to donate to NPOs was assessed. Thus, the reliability of measurement scales was studied. The individual reliability of the items was evaluated through the loadings of the indicators. In general, a high level of internal consistency was shown (Table 4). In this case, all the loadings were greater than 0.708 except ALT2. However, the item was not removed because the loading was greater than 0.4, and all other indicators (below) were correct. The individual reliability of each construct was verified using two indicators, Dijkstra-Henseler's ρ_A and composite reliability (CR) (Hair et al., 2019). To evaluate convergent validity, the average variance extracted (AVE) was used, which was larger than 0.5 in all cases (Fornell & Larcker, 1981). Likewise, the Fornell-Larcker criterion indicated a satisfactory level of discriminant validity (Table 5). In addition, the HTMT evaluation was realized with discriminant validity when values were less than 0.90 (Henseler et al., 2015) (Table 5).

Using the bootstrapping resampling procedure, the structural model was analyzed after the validity and reliability of the measurement model were tested. Then we proceeded to analyze the structural model.

The explanatory capacity of the global structural model was assessed using the R^2 -value, which reflected the explained variance of the dependent construct (Hair et al., 2019). The R^2 -values were 0.453 for intention to donate to a NPO (Table 6). Table 6 also shows the structural model evaluation. Consequently, the path coefficients as well as their significance levels were examined to assess the proposed structural relationships (Hair et al., 2019) (Table 7). Thus, H1 and H2, which proposed the influence of altruism

and self-esteem on the intention to donate to a NPO, were not supported. However, as proposed in H3, trust was positively connected with intention to donate to a NPO, with the strongest relationship in the model ($\beta = 0.099$). Additionally, past behavior, donor attitude and brand identification had statistically significant influence on intention to donate ($\beta = 0.296$, $\beta = 0.136$ and 0.292 , respectively). Therefore, H4, H5 and H6 were also confirmed, with H4 and H5 having the strongest relationships in the model.

Discussion

The empirical findings confirmed the positive and significant relationship among trust, donor attitude, past behavior, brand identification and the intention to donate to NPOs.

Contrary to our expectations, altruism and self-esteem did not have statistically significant impact on the intention to donate. Altruism has emerged as one of the most controversial concepts in the social and behavioral sciences (Bykov, 2017). Previous work has discussed naïve theories of altruism and focused on the norm of self-interest. These scholars have suggested that helping, when motivated by emotion, is selfish because emotional actors are motivated by intrinsic rewards rather than a desire to help others (Barasch et al., 2014; Bykov, 2017; Khurana, 2021). These authors proposed that although people may want to help others (e.g., by supporting charitable causes), they often hesitate to do so unless they can justify to themselves and others that their behavior serves their own self-interest. According to this approach, the logic inherent in altruism as a determinant of prosocial behavior must be discounted when individuals are motivated by the outcomes (material, social or intrapsychic) that derive from that behavior.

Previous studies suggested a possible explanation based on the influence of the context in which the donation takes place. Konrath and Handy (2018) stated that donors' motives may be conditioned by the context in which donations are made. Such contexts may support greater socially enacted rewards, thereby decreasing the relative importance of pure altruism (Gleasure & Feller, 2016).

Although many previous studies indicated that charitable giving may be motivated by donors' self-esteem (i.e., Konrath & Handy, 2018; Middleton & Lee, 2020; Wallace et al., 2017), the results found in this research did not empirically support this relationship, contradicting the proposed research hypothesis. Following Zhong and Lin (2018), there are complicated arguments about the relationship among self-affirmation, self-esteem, and prosocial behavior.

Despite numerous studies supporting the seemingly ubiquitous relationship between giving and emotional

Table 4 Measurement model evaluation (Mode A)

Construct/associated items (Mode A)	Loading	Alpha Cronbach	Dijkstra-Henseler's rho (ρ_A)	CR	AVE
<i>Altruism</i>					
ALT1	0.869***	0.725	0.814	0.841	0.645
ALT2	0.594***				
ALT3	0.908***				
<i>Trust</i>					
TRUST1	0.917***	0.954	0.960	0.965	0.845
TRUST2	0.940***				
TRUST3	0.948***				
<i>Past Behaviour</i>					
PB1	0.922***	0.870	0.872	0.921	0.795
PB2	0.914***				
PB3	0.838***				
<i>Self-Esteem</i>					
SELF1	0.921***	0.777	0.793	0.899	0.817
SELF2	0.887***				
<i>Donor Attitude</i>					
ATT1	0.848***	0.956	0.959	0.963	0.763
ATT2	0.846***				
ATT3	0.886***				
ATT4	0.907***				
ATT5	0.912***				
ATT6	0.831***				
ATT7	0.876***				
ATT8	0.880***				
<i>Brand Identification</i>					
BI1	0.901***	0.926	0.929	.0945	0.775
BI2	0.916***				
BI3	0.769***				
BI4	0.908***				
BI5	0.900***				
<i>Intention to Donate</i>					
INT1	0.922***	0.951	0.951	0.968	0.910
INT2	0.914***				

$n = 5,000$ subsample: *** $p < 0.001$ (one-tailed t Student) $t(0.05; 4,999) = 1.645$; $t(0.01; 4,999) = 2.327$; $t(0.001; 4,999) = 3.092$; CR = composite reliability index; AVE = average variance extracted

benefits, prosocial acts do not always increase emotional benefits (Aknin et al., 2013; Weinstein & Ryan, 2010). According to Dunn et al. (2014), these benefits are more likely to occur when the donation satisfies one or more of the donor's basic human needs (relatedness, competence, and autonomy).

One of the primary factors influencing the intention to donate is trust, which is expected to have a positive impact on the intention to donate (Alhidari et al., 2018; Becker et al., 2020; Konrath & Handy, 2018). Although our study found a statistically significant relationship between trust and intention to donate, it is important to emphasize that

the analysis of the influence of trust requires further study because it is a complex phenomenon determined by the interaction of multiple causes.

Different authors identified some relevant issues that have not yet been fully tested. Thus, first, it remains to be fully demonstrated whether trust is an antecedent or a consequence of giving behavior. The available empirical evidence demonstrates only an association between the two constructs but not a causal relationship (Chapman et al., 2021). Furthermore, the conceptualization of trust cannot be limited to a single conceptual or operational level (Becker et al., 2020). Trust in NPOs is fundamentally

Table 5 Measurement model: discriminant validity

Fornell-Larcker Criterion								HTMT							
	ALT	TRUST	PB	SELF	ATT	BI	INT		ALT	TRUST	PB	SELF	ATT	BI	INT
ALT	0.803							ALT							
TRUST	0.370	0.919						TRUST	0.470						
PB	0.389	0.253	0.892					PB	0.476	0.279					
SELF	0.578	0.407	0.327	0.904				SELF	0.751	0.474	0.391				
ATT	0.505	0.378	0.147	0.406	0.874			ATT	0.505	0.395	0.159	0.466			
BI	0.469	0.504	0.449	0.478	0.239	0.880		BI	0.550	0.536	0.501	0.569	0.254		
INT	0.430	0.418	0.513	0.432	0.335	0.563	0.954	INT	0.491	0.437	0.563	0.499	0.348	0.600	

ALT: altruism; TRUST: trust; PB: Past Behaviour; SELF: Self-Esteem; ATT: Donor Attitude; BI: Brand Identification; INT: Intention to Donate to NPO. Fornell-Larcker criterion: diagonal elements (bold) are the square root of the variance shared between the constructs and their measures (average variance extracted). Off-diagonal elements should be larger than off-diagonal elements. AVE: average variance extracted

Table 6 Structural model evaluation (Sample N = 300)

Construct/structural path		R ²	f ²	VIF
H1	Altruism Intention to donate to nonprofit organization	0.453	0.002	1.785
H2	Self-Esteem Intention to donate to nonprofit organization		0.006	1.742
H3	Trust Intention to donate to nonprofit organization		0.012	1.506
H4	Past Behaviour Intention to donate to nonprofit organization		0.121	1.326
H5	Donor Attitude Intention to donate to nonprofit organization		0.025	1.357
H6	Brand Identification Intention to donate to nonprofit organization		0.089	1.757

Table 7 Results of hypothesis testing (Sample N = 300). One-tailed test

Hypothesis/structural path		β	t-value	p value	Result
H1	Altruism Intention to donate to nonprofit organization	0.040 ^{ns}	0.720	0.236	Rejected
H2	Self-esteem Intention to donate to nonprofit organization	0.077 ^{ns}	1.469	0.071	Rejected
H3	Trust Intention to donate to nonprofit organization	0.099*	2.173	0.015	Accepted
H4	Past Behaviour Intention to donate to nonprofit organization	0.296***	4.559	0.000	Accepted
H5	Donor Attitude Intention to donate to nonprofit organization	0.136**	3.010	0.001	Accepted
H6	Brand Identification Intention to donate to nonprofit organization	0.292***	4.319	0.000	Accepted

n = 5000 subsample: *** $p < .001$ (one-tailed t Student) $t(0.05; 4999) = 1.645$; $t(0.01; 4999) = 2.327$; $t(0.001; 4999) = 3.092$

dependent on the specific relationship between the individual and the organization.

In the present research, a statistically significant relationship between past donation behavior and intention to donate was found. This relationship was demonstrated in several previous studies (Kashif & De Run, 2015; Knowles et al., 2012; Smith & McSweeney, 2007; Van der Linden, 2011). To explain this finding, it can be argued that past behavior operates as a risk-reducing mechanism. That is, a past experience that is positive will most likely lead to repeated behavior, as the associated perceived risk is much lower in such cases (Michaelidou et al., 2015; Sargeant et al., 2008). Nevertheless, one donation experience with a

given charity may not be enough to encourage the intention to donate again. This experience (and relationship) must be positive to significantly influence donors' willingness to continue donating to an organization to which they have previously donated (Beldad et al., 2014).

The findings in the present study revealed that donors' attitudes significantly contribute to the intention to donate money. Similar findings were found in previous research, such as that of Smith and McSweeney (2007), Mittelman and Rojas-Mendez (2018) and Peasley et al. (2018).

To enhance (or maintain) positive attitudes toward charitable giving, it can be useful for campaigns to remind the community of how their contributions have translated

(or will translate) into tangible benefits for aid recipients at local, national and international levels (Knowles et al., 2012). This approach can also have the potential benefit of increasing trust and confidence in the practices of the charitable organization.

The results of this research proved that identification with the brand of the NPO contributes significantly to the intention to donate. This finding is consistent with results of previous studies such as those of Hou et al. (2014) and Peasley et al. (2018). One possible explanation for this influence is based on the principles of social identity theory and organizational identity theory. That is, Sargeant (2013) stated that donors are attracted to (and perhaps remain loyal to) brands that they perceive to have a personality that encompasses values congruent with their own, whether real or aspirational.

However, the limitations of the foregoing explanation must be considered in future research. Although identity theory explains the specific outcomes of identification in the nonprofit sector, very little is known regarding how identification with a cause or recipient group impacts the relationship between members and the organization (Payne et al., 2019). In short, it is critical to differentiate between identification with the organization (brand) and identification with the cause or recipients.

Implications

One of the main implications for managers of NPOs is that it is necessary to secure the trust of donors by enhancing the reputation of the organization (Torres-Moraga et al., 2010). To achieve this trust, the key would be to provide effective communication between the organization and the donor, thereby strengthening the donor's familiarity with the NPO. These communications should focus on conveying the work and actions of the organization. Therefore, real images, videos, and objective information about the use of donations should be used to attract potential donors who are seeking information about potential projects with which to become involved (Chen et al., 2019). This will help improve perceived trust and lead to a greater intention to donate. In addition, possible recommendations include implementing social media campaigns or direct marketing actions to more effectively communicate appropriate information to potential donors, as suggested by Romero Domínguez et al. (2021).

In this study, the influence of past donation behavior was analyzed. For those with some donation experience, the organization should emphasize information that is more closely related to the individual's own donation behavior (Mínguez & Sese, 2021).

A recent study conducted by Saeri et al. (2022) was noteworthy in this area. Those authors conducted a meta-review to identify which actions promoted charitable donations. They identified four main strategies described as focusing on individual victims, increasing the publicity of donations, discussing the impact of donation and both ensuring and promoting the tax-deductible status of their charity.

Individuals who are socially attached to a group tend to adopt supportive behaviors and are more inclined to participate in them (Payne et al., 2019). In particular, those authors observed that so-called "attitude homophily" describes the feelings of similarity that individuals have with others and is significantly related to each dimension of identification. Thus, it is proposed that NPOs build brand messages based on increasing donors' attitudes through identification. By studying the characteristics of each of the targets identified by the NPOs, more tailored communications could be developed.

Limitations and Future Research

The present study has several limitations. First, the chosen sample is geographically limited. Future studies could include an analysis with participants from different countries to carry out a cross-sectional study. According to Ng et al. (2011) and Middleton and Lee (2020), donating behavior is influenced by culture. Second, the relationship between the variables is analyzed according to the individual donors of the NPO, which could limit the generalizability of the study's findings.

Additionally, it would be interesting to consider food, a type of donation that has current importance. Food banks are essential organizations that deliver groceries to food-insecure families. However, food donations could have declined in recent decades due to strict laws proposed by the economic and public food security regulatory authorities. Belton et al. (2020) stated that food aid organizations rely heavily on donated food and are constrained by budget, equipment, and staffing considerations.

Another possible future direction of research should investigate how the leadership style practiced in NPOs influences donors. An understanding of NPO leadership styles can assist managers in building stable relationships that increase donor retention (Enchil, 2020). In this research area, Haski-Leventhal and Foot (2016) and Blouin et al. (2018) suggested that innovative change and disclosure regarding marketing and fundraising by NPO leaders could attract charitable donations from households while enhancing accountability and public trust. More recently, Shier and Handy (2020) proposed an initial conceptual

framework for the facilitative role of executive leaders in shaping the orientation of human services organizations.

Declarations

Conflict of interest The authors did not receive support from any organization for the submitted work. The authors have no relevant financial or non-financial interests to disclose.

Human or Animal Participants All procedures performed in this study involving human participants were in accordance with the ethical standards of the University of Castilla-La Mancha and the 1964 Helsinki Declaration and its later amendments or comparable ethical standards.

Informed Consent Participants gave informed consent via the statement “I am aware that my responses are confidential, and I agree to participate in this survey” where an affirmative reply was required. They were able to withdraw from the survey at any time without giving a reason. All participants acknowledged an informed consent statement in order to participate in the study. They were not financially compensated for their participation.

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